

SEMESTER 1 DIPLOMA HANDBOOK

Communication Skills in English

A complete English communication textbook for reading, grammar, vocabulary, speaking, workplace communication, writing, exam questions and full answers.

Course Code

1001

Credits

4

Periods

4/week, 60/semester

Course Details

Title: Communication Skills in English

Programme: Diploma in Engineering and Technology / Commercial Practice / Management

Category: Humanities and Social Science

Pattern: L:4, T:0, P:0

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OBJECTIVES AND OUTCOMES

Course Objectives, Prerequisite, Outcomes and Mapping

Course Objectives

1. To cultivate competence in listening to and comprehending various information, opinions and ideas, both formal and informal.
2. To develop proficiency, fluency and confidence in oral communication and use English with ease in everyday and workplace contexts.
3. To acquaint learners with reading strategies to construct meaning and interpret articles, technical documents and narratives.
4. To familiarize learners with writing discourses ranging from technical to aesthetic with accuracy, brevity and clarity.

Course Prerequisite

Basic knowledge of English reading and writing at Secondary School level.

CO-PO Mapping

CO1 → PO6: 1 weakly mapped. CO2 → PO6: 3 strongly mapped. CO3 → PO7: 3 strongly mapped. CO4 → PO6: 3 strongly mapped.

CO	Outcome	Durati on	Level
CO 1	Listen to, identify and comprehend main idea and supporting details of a listening passage.	3 hours	Analysi ng
CO 2	Apply different language functions and communicate effectively in workplace and daily life.	10 hours	Creatin g
CO 3	Read, comprehend and analyze ideas in articles, technical writings and narratives and express them in own words.	20 hours	Creatin g
CO 4	Apply writing techniques and compose technical documents like reports and emails.	25 hours	Creatin g

ROADMAP

Module-wise Learning Roadmap

1	Gift of the Magi; workplace/technical passage	Concord; meaning from context	Self-introduction; stating opinion	Graph report
2	Stopping by the Woods; workplace/technology passage	Time and tense; signal words	Opinion with reasons; presentation	Slide preparation
3	Malgudi Days - Astrologer's Day excerpts	Homophones, homonyms, affixes, passive voice	Asking permission	Email; process description
4	Night of the Scorpion; workplace/technology passage	Synonyms, antonyms, reported speech	Agreement/disagreement; instructions	Paragraph writing

MODULE 1

Reading, Concord, Self-introduction, Opinion and Graph Report

Module Outcomes

- M1.01 Read with comprehension.
- M1.02 Use context clues for unfamiliar words.
- M1.03 Introduce oneself.
- M1.04 State opinion using suitable structures.
- M1.05 Write technical reports effectively.

Gift of the Magi

This section studies the story through summary and interpretation without reproducing the copyrighted text. The story highlights selfless love, sacrifice, irony and emotional value. The couple sacrifice their precious possessions to buy gifts for each other. The ending is ironic because the gifts become practically unusable, but emotionally priceless.

Reading Strategies

Use skimming for general idea, scanning for details, inference for implied meaning and summarising for expressing the passage in your own words.

Concord

Rule	Correct Example
Singular subject + singular verb	The technician checks the panel.
Plural subject + plural verb	The technicians check the panel.
Each/every/either/neither takes singular verb	Each student has a notebook.
Subject joined by and usually takes plural verb	The supervisor and the trainee are present.

Context Clues

Guess meaning using definition, example, contrast and cause-effect clues. Example: "The device is portable, so it can be carried easily." Portable means easy to carry.

Self-introduction Sample

Good morning. My name is Arun Kumar. I am from Thrissur and I am a first-semester diploma student in Electronics Engineering. My strengths are punctuality, teamwork and willingness to learn. I am interested in technical writing and public speaking. My short-term goal is to improve my communication skills and perform well in my diploma course. Thank you.

Graph Report Sample

The graph shows the number of students who attended workshop sessions from January to April. In January, 45 students attended. The number increased to 60 in February and reached the highest point of 75 in March. In April, attendance slightly decreased to 68. Overall, attendance showed a rising trend, with March recording the best participation.

Expected Questions: Define concord. Explain context clues. Write a self-introduction. Discuss sacrifice in Gift of the Magi. Write a graph report from given data.

MODULE 2

Poetry, Tense, Signal Words, Reasons and Presentation

Module Outcomes

- Read and understand.
- Use words accurately.
- Use tense accurately.
- Use linking words for sequence, cause and effect.
- Make effective presentations.

Stopping by the Woods

The poem is studied through theme and interpretation without copying the full text. It creates a calm, silent and reflective mood. The speaker pauses near beautiful woods but remembers duties and promises. The main message is that beauty and rest are attractive, but responsibility must be fulfilled.

Time and Tense

Tense	Use	Example
Simple present	Facts/routines	The machine operates smoothly.
Present continuous	Action happening now	The technician is checking the wiring.
Simple past	Completed action	The team completed the inspection.
Present perfect	Past action with present result	I have submitted the report.

Signal Words

Sequence: first, next, finally. Cause: because, since. Effect: therefore, as a result. Contrast: however, although. Conclusion: overall, to sum up.

Opinion with Reasons

In my opinion, communication skills are essential for diploma students. The main reason is that technical knowledge becomes useful only when we can explain it clearly. For example, a technician must report faults, describe procedures and communicate with supervisors. Therefore, English communication improves academic and workplace success.

Presentation Outline

1. Title slide
2. Introduction
3. Main point 1
4. Main point 2
5. Example/application
6. Conclusion and thank you

Expected Questions: Explain mood in Stopping by the Woods. Use signal words in a process. Explain tenses with examples. Prepare a slide outline.

MODULE 3

Main Ideas, Word Usage, Passive Voice, Email and Process Description

Module Outcomes

- Identify main ideas using reading strategies.
- Understand and use new words.
- Use words with correct nuance.
- Use passive voice.
- Compose business emails.
- Describe a process.

Astrologer's Day

This section studies the prescribed excerpt through interpretation only. The story uses a lively marketplace setting, suspense, irony and a surprise ending. It explores appearance and reality, cleverness, fate, guilt and survival.

Homophones, Homonyms and Affixes

Topic ⁰⁰¹	Meaning	Example
Homophones	Same sound, different spelling/meaning	write/right, brake/break
Homonyms	Same spelling or sound, different meaning	bank, light
Prefix	Added before a root word	unsafe, rewrite
Suffix	Added after a root word	development, useful

Passive Voice

Passive voice is used when action or result is more important than the doer. Structure: object + be verb + past participle.

Active: The engineer repaired the machine.
 Passive: The machine was repaired by the engineer.

Formal Email Sample

To: hod@example.edu
 Subject: Request for Permission to Attend Technical Workshop

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am a first-semester diploma student of Electronics Engineering. I request your permission to attend a technical workshop on Basics of Industrial Automation scheduled for 15 July at the seminar hall.

The workshop will help me improve my technical awareness. I assure you that I will complete any missed classwork.

Kindly grant me permission to attend the programme.

Thank you.
 Yours faithfully,
 Arun Kumar
 S1 Electronics Engineering

Process Description Sample

First, the message is typed in an email application. Next, the receiver's address and subject are entered. After that, the send button is clicked. The message is transferred through mail servers. Finally, it reaches the receiver's inbox.

Expected Questions: Differentiate homophones and homonyms. Convert active to passive. Write a permission email. Describe a process.

MODULE 4

Reported Speech, Agreement, Instructions and Paragraph Writing

Module Outcomes

- Read and comprehend ideas.
- Understand new words and usage.
- Report direct speech accurately.
- Agree/disagree politely.
- Give instructions clearly.
- Write coherent paragraphs.

Night of the Scorpion

The poem is studied without reproducing the full text. It presents pain, fear, rural life, superstition and motherhood. The mother suffers after a scorpion sting, and her final concern for her children reveals selfless love.

Synonyms and Antonyms

Word	Synonym	Antonym
brief	short/concise	long
accurate	correct/exact	wrong
polite	respectful	rude
increase	rise	decrease

Reported Speech

Direct: The supervisor said, "The machine is ready."
Reported: The supervisor said that the machine was ready.

Common changes: is/am → was, are → were, will → would, can → could, today → that day.

Polite Agreement and Disagreement

Agreement: I agree with your point. That is a valid suggestion. Disagreement: I understand your point, but... I respectfully disagree because...

Instructions Sample

1. Check whether the power cable is connected.
2. Switch on the UPS before switching on the computer.
3. Do not install unknown software.
4. Save your work in the assigned folder.
5. Shut down the computer after use.

Paragraph Sample

English communication is important for diploma students because it supports academic and professional growth. Students need English to understand technical resources, write reports, attend interviews and communicate in workplaces. Good communication also improves confidence during presentations and group discussions. Therefore, English communication is a useful skill for every diploma student.

Expected Questions: Explain motherhood in Night of the Scorpion. Change direct speech to reported speech. Write instructions. Write a paragraph.

GRAMMAR BANK

Quick Grammar Revision

Concord

Singular subject takes singular verb. Plural subject takes plural verb. Each/every takes singular verb.

Tense

Use present for facts, past for completed actions, perfect for present result and future for future actions.

Passive Voice

Object + be + past participle. Example: The report was submitted.

Reported Speech

Remove quotes, change pronouns and backshift tense when needed.

VOCABULARY BANK

Vocabulary Revision

Context Clues

Use surrounding words to guess meaning.

Synonyms

Similar meaning: brief - concise, correct - accurate.

Antonyms

Opposite meaning: accept - reject, increase - decrease.

COMMUNICATION PRACTICE

Speaking Functions

Self-introduction

Greeting + name + place + course + strengths + interests + goal + thanks.

Opinion

In my opinion... The main reason is... For example...

Permission

May I request permission to...? Kindly allow me to...

Disagreement

I understand your point, but... I respectfully disagree because...

WRITING TEMPLATES

Templates for Writing Tasks

Graph Report

The graph shows ____ during _____. The highest value was _____. The lowest value was _____. Overall, the data indicates _____.

Email

Subject + salutation + purpose + details + polite request + thanks + signature.

Process

Paragraph

Topic sentence + supporting details + example + concluding sentence.

MODEL QUESTION PAPER

Model Paper with Full Answers

The order follows a standard language-paper flow: reading/literature, grammar/vocabulary, and communication/writing. It is not an exact copy of any official paper.

Part A - Reading and Literature

Passage: Digital payment systems have become common in shops, colleges, transport services and offices. They allow users to transfer money quickly through mobile applications, cards or internet banking. These systems reduce the need to carry cash and help organisations maintain clear transaction records. However, users must be careful while entering passwords, scanning QR codes and sharing personal information. A secure digital payment habit includes checking the receiver's name, using strong passwords, avoiding public Wi-Fi and keeping proof of payment.

1. What is the main idea of the passage?
2. Mention two advantages of digital payment systems.
3. Why should users be careful?
4. Find a word that means ease of use.
5. Write a suitable title.
6. Write a five-sentence summary.
7. Explain love and sacrifice in Gift of the Magi.
8. Explain mood and imagery in Stopping by the Woods.
9. How does the setting of Astrologer's Day create suspense?
10. Discuss motherhood and superstition in Night of the Scorpion.

Part B - Grammar and Vocabulary

1. Each of the students ____ an identity card. (has/have)
2. The technician and supervisor ____ inspecting the panel. (is/are)
3. Yesterday, the class ____ a presentation. (prepare/prepared)
4. The report ____ already been submitted. (has/have)

5. Give a synonym of brief and antonym of accept.

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6. Write a homophone pair in a sentence.

7. Change to passive: The engineer repaired the machine.

8. Change to reported speech: The teacher said, "I will check your reports tomorrow."

9. Correct: The quality of the products are good.

Part C - Communication and Writing

1. Prepare a self-introduction for a campus interview.
2. State your opinion: English communication is necessary for diploma students.
3. Write a graph report: January 40, February 55, March 70, April 65 students attended a workshop.
4. Write an email requesting permission to attend a technical workshop.
5. Describe the process of preparing a presentation.
6. Write instructions for safe use of a computer lab.
7. Write a paragraph on Importance of Teamwork in Technical Education.
8. Prepare a five-slide outline for Benefits of Computers.

FULL ANSWER KEY

Complete Model Answers

Part A Answers

Passage Answers

1. The passage explains the usefulness of digital payments and the need to use them safely.
2. They allow quick money transfer and reduce the need to carry cash. They also help maintain transaction records.
3. Users should be careful because unsafe password use, wrong QR codes or sharing personal information can lead to fraud.
4. Convenience means ease of use.
5. Safe Use of Digital Payment Systems.
6. Digital payment systems are widely used in modern life. They help people transfer money quickly through mobile apps, cards and internet banking. They reduce the need for cash and help maintain records. Users must protect passwords, check receiver details and avoid unsafe networks. Therefore, digital payments are useful when used with care and awareness.

Literature Answers

Gift of the Magi: The story presents love as selfless sacrifice. The poor couple give up their precious possessions to buy meaningful gifts for each other. The gifts become practically unusable, but emotionally priceless. The story teaches that true love is measured by care and sacrifice, not money.

Stopping by the Woods: The poem creates a calm and reflective mood through images of woods, snow, darkness and silence. The speaker is attracted by rest and beauty, but remembers duties. The message is that responsibility must be fulfilled.

Astrologer's Day: The busy marketplace, dim light and mysterious atmosphere create suspense. The astrologer's hidden past and the arrival of a stranger turn an ordinary scene into a tense situation.

Night of the Scorpion: The poem shows rural superstition, community fear and motherly love. The villagers respond with prayers and beliefs, while the mother suffers silently. Her final concern for her children reveals selfless motherhood.

Part B Answers

Grammar

1. Each of the students **has** an identity card.
2. The technician and supervisor **are** inspecting the panel.
3. Yesterday, the class **prepared** a presentation.
4. The report **has** already been submitted.
5. Synonym of brief: concise/short. Antonym of accept: reject.
6. Please **write** the **right** answer.
7. The machine was repaired by the engineer.
8. The teacher said that he/she would check our reports the next day.
9. The quality of the products **is** good.

Part C Full Model Answers

Self-introduction:

Good morning. My name is Anil Kumar. I am from Mysore, and I am a first-semester diploma student in Mechanical Engineering. I completed my school education with interest in science and practical work. My strengths are sincerity, creativity and teamwork. I enjoy learning new technical skills. My career goal is to become a skilled technician and contribute responsibly to industry. Thank you for giving me this opportunity.

Opinion Answer:

In my opinion, English communication is necessary for diploma students. The first reason is that students need English to understand technical books, manuals, online resources and workplace instructions. The second reason is that good communication helps students perform better in interviews, presentations and industrial training. Therefore, English communication is important for academic success and professional growth.

Graph Report:

The data shows the number of students who attended an English communication workshop from January to April. In January, 40 students attended the workshop. The number increased to 55 in February and reached the highest point of 70 in March. In April, attendance slightly decreased to 65. Overall, the workshop attendance showed a rising trend from January to March, followed by a small fall in April.

Formal Email:

To: hod@example.edu

Subject: Request for Permission to Attend Technical Workshop

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am a first-semester diploma student. I request your permission to attend a technical workshop on Basics of Industrial Automation scheduled for 15 July. The workshop will help me improve my technical awareness. I assure you that I will complete any missed classwork and submit all pending work on time.

Kindly grant me permission to attend the workshop.

Thank you.

Yours faithfully,

Anil Kumar

Process Description:

First, the topic of the presentation is selected according to the purpose and audience. Next, important points are collected from reliable sources. After that, the ideas are arranged in a logical order. Then, short slides are prepared with headings and bullet points. Finally, the presentation is practised aloud to improve fluency, timing and confidence.

Instructions for Computer Lab:

1. Enter the computer lab only with permission.
2. Keep bags and water bottles away from computers.
3. Do not install unknown software.

4. Save your work in the assigned folder.

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5. Inform the instructor if any device is damaged.

6. Shut down the computer properly after use.

Paragraph:

Teamwork is very important in technical education because many practical tasks are completed by groups. When students work as a team, they can share ideas, divide responsibilities and solve problems faster. Teamwork also improves communication, patience and leadership skills. It prepares students for industry, where technicians, engineers and supervisors work together. Therefore, teamwork is an essential quality for every diploma student.

Presentation Outline:

Slide 1: Benefits of Computers - title and presenter details.

Slide 2: Introduction - computers are useful in education, industry and daily life.

Slide 3: Speed and Accuracy - computers process data quickly and reduce errors.

Slide 4: Uses - learning, design, automation, records and communication.

Slide 5: Conclusion - computers improve productivity when used properly.

REFERENCES

References and Online Resources

T1: Course Book prepared by SITTTTR, Kalamassery. R1: J.D. O'Connor, Better English Pronunciation. R2: Margaret M. Maison, Examine your English. R3: M. Ashraf Rizvi, Effective Technical Communication. R4: John Nielson, Effective Communication Skills. R5: Oxford Dictionary. R6: Roget's Thesaurus. R7: Collins English Dictionary.

Online: NPTEL, British Council, Cambridge English, Poem Hunter, EnglishClub and SlideShare.